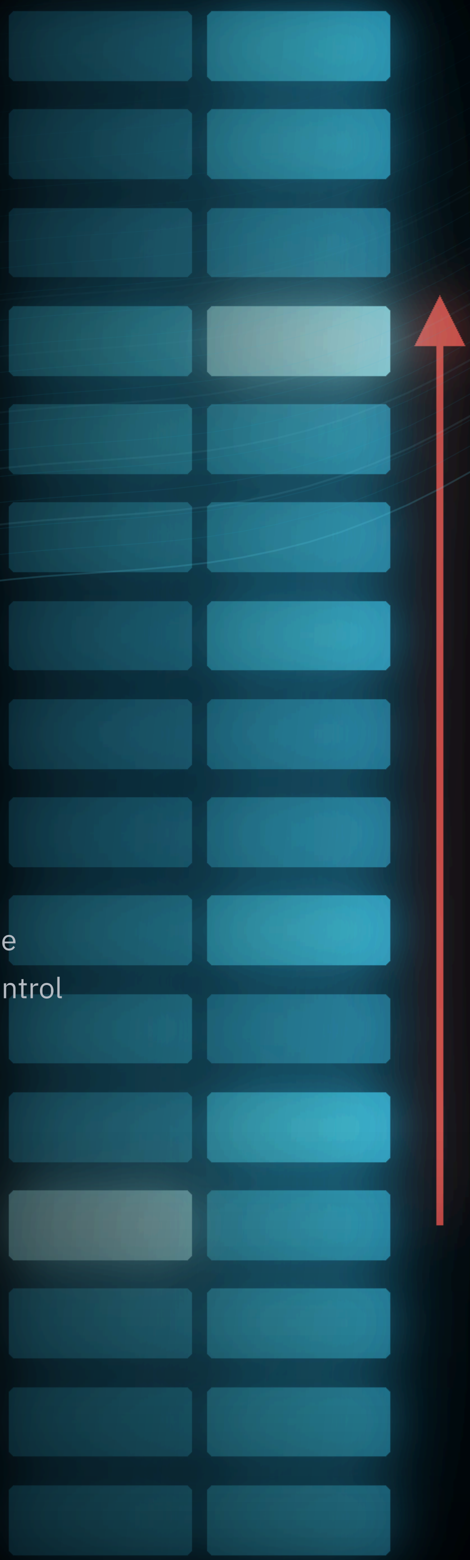
LESSON NINE

ABSORPTION AND THE POC FLIP



The trap printed on the footprint: candle against delta, the four step absorption plan, and the POC flip that shows control changing hands.

By Sires

Ether, the free side of Ethos

Contents

This guide pairs with the video. **Watch it** for the live walkthrough, keep this next to the charts.

Absorption on the footprint

Same trap as the ladder, now visible in the prints. Absorption happens when retail traders buy heavily at a key level expecting the breakout, and institutions use those exact orders to sell into. Price reverses quickly and the breakout buyers are trapped.

Absorption on the footprint. The aggression prints, the level holds, the reversal follows.

On the footprint the trap has a signature: the candle and the delta disagree.

WHY THE FOOTPRINT VERSION MATTERS

The DOM shows absorption as it happens, the footprint proves it after the candle closes. When both agree at your level, that is as good as the trigger layer gets.

The four step plan

The four step plan, straight from the desk.

- **Step 1, mark the key levels**
  Support and resistance zones where traders are likely to get trapped: old highs and lows, ledges, value edges.

- **Step 2, watch the approach**
  As price nears the level, get the order flow up: delta against the candle is the read you are waiting for.

- **Step 3, spot the disagreement**
  Bullish absorption: the candle is bullish but delta is negative, sellers are aggressive yet price still rises.
  Bearish absorption: the candle is bearish but delta is positive, buyers are aggressive yet price still falls.

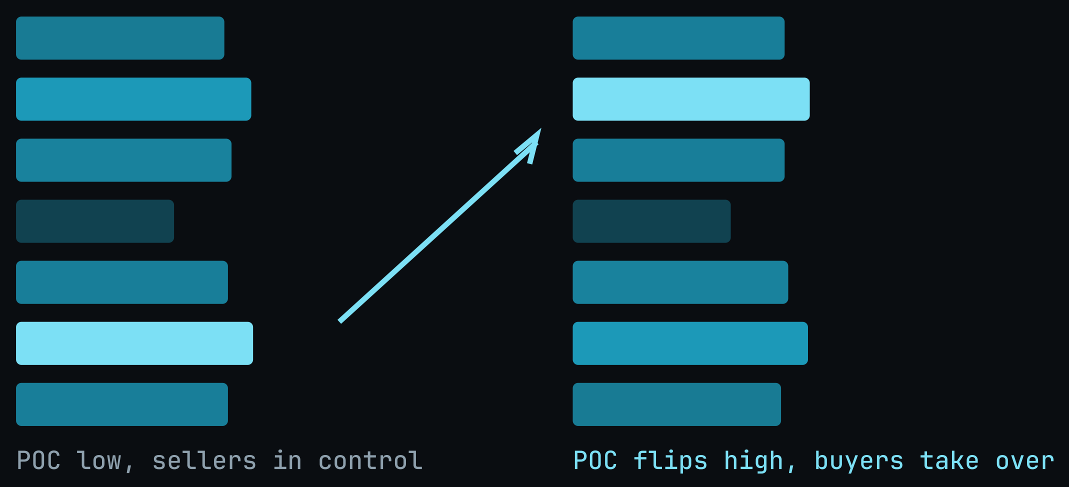
- **Step 4, interpret the trap**
  The aggressive side is stuck on the wrong side while institutions quietly build the opposite position. Trade with the institutions, against the trapped.

The disagreement printed: aggressive flow one way, price the other. Someone big is taking the other side.

The POC flip

The second tell in this lesson lives inside a single candle. Every candle has its own point of control, the price where the most volume traded.

A POC flip is that busiest price jumping to the other side of the candle. Control just changed hands.



The POC flip. The heaviest business moves from one extreme of the candle to the other, buyers and sellers have swapped control.

HOW TO READ IT

POC low in the candle then flipping high means the business moved up with conviction. At a key level, a flip in your direction is confirmation the level is being defended.

Delta divergence

The most powerful confirmation on the footprint is delta divergence, and it comes in two flavours you need to name on sight.

Bearish delta divergence: price grinds to a fresh high while cumulative delta rolls over. The buying is passive, the aggressive side is quietly selling.

REGULAR DIVERGENCE

Price makes a new high or low but delta does not. The move has no aggressive fuel behind it. It is running on fumes, expect a reversal.

EXHAUSTION PRINT

At the extreme, a huge delta bar prints and price refuses to extend. The last aggressive push got absorbed. The turn is usually one or two candles away.

WHY IT BEATS PRICE ALONE

Price tells you where the market went, delta tells you whether anyone aggressive took it there. When they disagree, believe the delta, the move without conviction is the one that fails.

Stacking the tells

The tells work best stacked, at a level, in sequence.

Level, then absorption, then flip

Price reaches your level, delta disagrees with the candle, then the POC flips your way. That sequence is the full confirmation stack.

One tell is interest, two is a trade

Absorption alone says someone is defending. Absorption plus the flip plus divergence says they are winning.

The DOM completes the picture

Lesson 6's ladder reads plus this lesson's prints are the same event from two angles. When they agree, execute.

Now spot the trap.

You can now prove the trap in the prints instead of feeling it in your stop-outs. Inside Ethos, the mentorship, the KG models trade these confirmations live, three sessions a week.

- **Candle against delta**
  The disagreement IS the signal. Agreement is just a trend.
- **The flip confirms control**
  The busiest price switching sides is conviction printed.
- **Stack the tells at a level**
  Absorption plus flip plus your level. Then execute.

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